

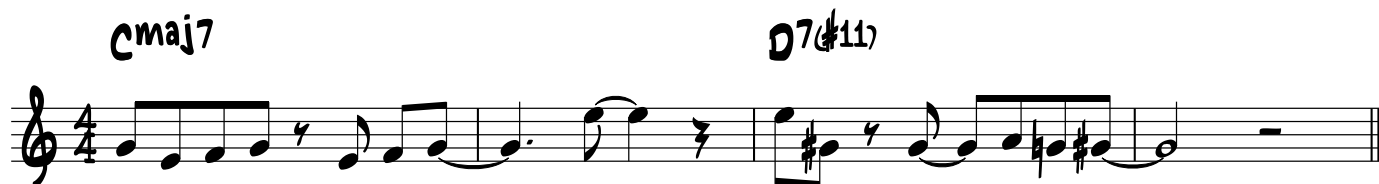
SORT OUT YOUR #11's!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #187

All jazz musicians, pretty quickly in their improvisation journey, are faced with nasty chord looking extensions. b9's and #11's and b13's and much more. An assumption many of us make is that the extensions and alterations are to make the chord more intricate, more dense, and more aggressive sounding. More "outside." Here's the thing . . . that is often NOT the case. Very often, those gnarly looking chord extensions are to make the chord more diatonic. They make the chord more "inside"!

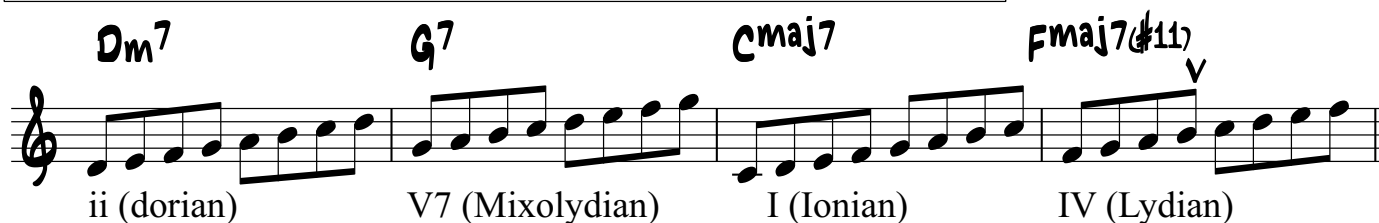
Example #1 shows a melody where the #11 in the third measure is outside the key of the song (ie. the key of C major). This #11 makes the song less diatonic, more "outside."

#1 - Etude based on "A Train" chord changes, first four measures



Other songs use the #11 to keep us more diatonic. Example #2 shows the chord changes to the first four measures of "Autumn Leaves." Here, the fourth measure is a IV chord in our key of the song (ie. the key of C major). The #11 on the Fmaj7 chord makes the song *more* diatonic, not less. The #11 is an "inside" sounding note.

#2 - "Autumn Leaves" chord changes, first four measures



#3 - Etude based on "Autumn Leaves" chord changes, first four measures

